

HP Officejet 5610 All-in-One	HP Officejet 5680 All-in-One	HP Photosmart C4188 All-in-One	Lexmark X4270
			
8,999	9,999	7,999	7,500
+ Fax with ADF - Expensive	+ Fax with handset - Expensive	+ Superb print quality - No fax or ADF	+ Fax with handset - Below-par print quality
56.22	59.68	67.34	57.24
15.49	19.09	15.44	16.83
30.53	31.42	40.43	28.17
10.20	9.18	11.47	12.24
Thermal	Thermal	Thermal	Thermal
100 sheets	100 sheets	100 sheets	100
2	2	2	2
1200 x 2400 dpi	1200 x 2400 dpi	1200 x 2400 dpi	600 x 1200 dpi
48-bit	48-bit	48-bit	48-bit
Both	Both	Flatbed	Sheet-fed
✓	✓	✓	✓
✓	✓	✗	✓
100	100	50	30
✗	✓	NA	✓
5	5	6	4
6	6	6	6
5	5	7	5
5.9 kg	6 kg	5.4 kg	3.87 kg
435 x 418 x 235 mm	435 x 418 x 235 mm	434 x 290 x 162 mm	546 x 370 x 248 mm
Mono LCD	Mono LCD	Swivel Colour LCD	Mono LCD
None	None	SD, MS, MS Pro, SM, MMC, xD	None
✗	✗	✗	✗
None	None	Photo Paper Cassette	4-Port USB Hub
17.3 / 129.8 sec	17.1 / 123.8 sec	16.2 / 38.8 sec	15.1 / 171.1 sec
65.4 / 144.6 sec	65.6 / 141.9 sec	32.9 / 91.7 sec	130.3 / 354 sec
392.8 sec	390.9 sec	221.3 sec	1130 sec
7 / 7	7 / 7	7 / 7	5 / 5
6	6	6	5
6 / 4	6 / 8	6 / 8	4 / 6
7 / 7	7 / 7	7 / 8	4 / 4
7	7	7	4
6	6	8	5
8	8	8	8
6 / 6	6 / 6	6 / 8	5 / 4
7 / 7	7 / 7	8 / 7	5 / 6
7	7	8	5
16.5 sec	17.1 sec	9.3 sec	9 sec
111.7 sec	182.8 sec	71 sec	176.2 sec
31.2 / 68.7 sec	32.8 / 68.5 sec	24.7 / 37.3	15.3 / 150.7 sec
7 / 7	7 / 7	7 / 7	7 / 7
1 year	1 year	1 year	1 year

flimsy. Unlike the 4355, whose trays can be folded when not in use, the tray of the Lexmark has to be dismantled and stored separately—a bit of a pain. The Epson is also built fairly well, though its scanner lid is a little fragile. The Lexmark comes bundled with a 4-port USB hub.

The HP Officejet 5610, Photosmart C4188, and the Brother DCP-330C are all built very well—good enough to bear the rigours of office use. However, the HP 5610 has protruding trays that, though not flimsy, get easily dislodged from the MFD with the slightest of force. The HP 5610 is a no-frills, rugged office MFD with a mono LCD, while the C4188 is a photo MFD with special features such as a memory card reader, the reprint function, and a special side input tray to store 4 x 6 photo papers. Both the HP C4188 and the Brother DCP-330C have a swivel colour LCD. The C4188 has a Photo Fix function, which lets you apply effects to images on memory cards and digicams to improve print quality.

One feature we like about all the HP and Brother printers is that their cartridges replacement compartments are

conveniently placed on the front left corner, so you don't need to poke your hands about inside the bay. This is a good design



CANON PIXMA MP460
Quick copies, crisp prints

improvement, and we might well see an increasing number of printers and MFDs incorporating such a design.

The Brother MFC-240C and HP 5680 have Mono LCD screens, while the Canon MP460 has a swivelling colour LCD that lets you view photos from a memory card or camera connected to the PictBridge port, and even resize them. Just like the HP 5610, the 5680 is a no-frills MFD just for office use, and therefore does not feature a memory card reader or PictBridge.

Performance Printing

The Epson CX3900 is one of the slowest at black-and-white, normal-quality text